

Fit AI to the work. Bring the people with it.

A source-grounded point of view for enterprise AI adoption at SupplyHouse

EXECUTIVE THESIS

SupplyHouse should treat enterprise AI adoption as a fit-and-install discipline. Start with a valuable workflow. Define the data and context it can trust. Bound the AI role. Make human authority visible. Prove the result in the work. Then package the learning so the next team starts further ahead.

WHY NOW

Growth pressure

SupplyHouse and KKR announced a 2025 strategic partnership to support long-term growth while preserving culture.

Proven AI value

RELEX reports AI-driven forecasting and replenishment across four fulfillment centers reduced manual planning effort and improved supply-chain outcomes.

People-first objective

The role explicitly prioritizes listening, psychological safety, equitable access, employee confidence and skepticism as signal.

THE ACTUAL WORK

Turn distributed AI demand and point successes into a governed portfolio of adopted workflows that produce measurable business value, stronger employee capability and reusable enterprise learning.

OPERATING TENSIONS

Tension	What the role must preserve	What the role must change
Speed / trust	Momentum, curiosity, local initiative	Unclear authority, uneven controls, pilot theater
Enterprise / local	Business ownership and workflow expertise	Duplicated standards, tools and learning
Automation / agency	Human judgment and career pathways	Manual friction that does not require human discretion
Access / risk	Equitable opportunity to learn and contribute	Unmanaged use, shadow patterns and uneven enablement

COST OF LEAVING THE TENSION UNRESOLVED

Not catastrophe—operating drag: repeated experiments, inconsistent support, unclear ownership, uneven access, weak confidence and an inability to tell which local success should become an enterprise pattern.

Make the work visible before scaling it.

Connect stakeholder ownership to one qualitative fit standard

STAKEHOLDER TOPOLOGY

Outcome owners

Procurement, Operations, Sales, Customer Service and Finance leaders accountable for workflows and value.

Capability partners

IT, Data, Security, HR, Legal, Finance, vendors, managers and employee ambassadors.

People affected

Frontline employees, managers, support teams and customers whose work or experience changes.

DECISIONS THIS ROLE SHOULD MAKE EASIER

What work changes; which opportunities receive funding and technical capacity; what becomes a shared standard; where human judgment remains final; what escalates; what is repaired; and what is stopped.

THE FIVE FIT CONDITIONS

1. Job signal

A real workflow has observable friction, consequence and an accountable business owner.

2. Context + data

The sources, definitions, freshness, permissions and failure modes are understood well enough for the intended use.

3. AI role

Assist, analyze, recommend or act is explicit. The model does not quietly acquire decision authority.

4. Human authority

Approval, override, escalation, support and accountability are named before launch.

5. Proof + reuse

Workflow outcome, quality, appropriate reliance, adoption depth, confidence and access are measured.

Decision

Commission a bounded pilot, run discovery, repair the design, hold for readiness or keep the work human-led.

FIRST-120-DAY OUTCOME

Context

Verified portfolio, stakeholder, readiness and adoption map.

Proof

Two bounded workflows with scale, repair, hold or stop decisions.

Capability

Practical CoE, ambassador rhythm, enablement and governance patterns.

Direction

Second-wave portfolio and evidence-based investment narrative.

Keep ownership local. Make standards reusable.

A practical Center of Excellence should enable decisions—not become a queue

PORTFOLIO AND GOVERNANCE ARCHITECTURE

Decision	Accountable owner	Required partners	Evidence
Workflow outcome and adoption	Functional leader / process owner	Frontline users, Finance, adoption team	Baseline, user behavior, workflow result
Platform, integration and support	IT / Data leadership	Security, architecture, vendor, business owner	Reliability, access, data and support posture
Responsible-use boundaries	Legal / Compliance / Security	HR, Data, functional owner	Use restrictions, auditability, escalation
Role enablement and career pathway	HR + functional leadership	Managers, ambassadors, adoption team	Capability, confidence, access, support load
Scale / repair / hold / stop	Executive portfolio forum	Finance, business, IT, Legal, HR	Balanced pilot evidence and reusable learning

BALANCED SCORECARD

Business Cycle time, capacity, rework, backlog, service, margin or decision quality—selected per workflow.	Trust + quality Evaluation results, correction, override, escalation, auditability and appropriate reliance.	Adoption + capability Eligible use, depth, abandonment, confidence, equitable access, support demand and reusable components.
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CENTER OF EXCELLENCE DESIGN

Enabling core, not gatekeeping bureaucracy. The CoE provides fit standards, portfolio visibility, vendor and technical partnership, responsible-use patterns, role-based enablement, evaluation support, ambassador infrastructure and executive scorecards. Business owners remain accountable for the workflow and outcome.

PORTFOLIO DISPOSITION

Scale Evidence supports wider use with a named owner.	Repair Value remains but fit, controls or enablement need redesign.	Hold Readiness or evidence is insufficient.	Stop / human-led The work does not justify additional AI involvement.
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EXECUTIVE QUESTIONS

- Where has AI already improved work, and what made employees trust that change?
- Which workflows constrain growth, service, margin or capacity across more than one function?
- What skepticism is the organization hearing, and what might it be protecting?
- Which decisions should be enterprise standards, and which should remain local?
- What evidence would make the executive team comfortable scaling—or stopping—an AI pattern?

My advantage is integration across the whole adoption problem.

Verified evidence, reframed for the work—not reinvented

EVIDENCE MAP

Role need	Verified evidence	Transfer
Enterprise AI strategy and use-case prioritization	DudeWorth AI-readiness and opportunity frameworks; Vape-Jet AI-first operating transformation	Connect value, feasibility, data, governance, adoption burden, ownership and evidence
Culture, enablement and confidence	Amazon leadership routines and standard work; Vape-Jet training and operating accountability	Translate change into daily work, support and manager routines
CoE, ambassador and governance mechanisms	Cross-functional operating systems across engineering, quality, operations, customer and technical teams	Create enabling standards with locally accountable workflow owners
Business cases, ROI and executive communication	Operational prioritization, dashboards, technical talks, advisory frameworks, public-private feasibility work	Make assumptions, outcomes, risk and decision logic explicit
Technical and vendor partnership	Robotics, machine vision, ERP/Odoo, agentic workflows, RAG patterns, Python/SQL/JavaScript/TensorFlow exposure	Bridge business design, implementation constraints and accountable support

THE CREDIBLE HIRING QUESTION

Can an operator-technologist lead enterprise-wide AI adoption? My evidence says the integrated nature of the work is the point: I have repeatedly connected technology, workflow, people, controls, customer consequence and operating evidence. I would not pretend to know SupplyHouse's internal portfolio on day one. I would bring a disciplined way to learn it quickly, make decisions visible and build capability with the people doing the work.

CLOSING POSITION

The goal is not to maximize AI deployed. It is to make the organization better at choosing, installing, governing and improving AI-enabled work—while increasing employee capability and confidence.